

Product Review

OVERVIEW

Product name: ZORYVE (roflumilast) topical foam 0.3%
Category: Rx, topical phosphodiesterase-4 inhibitor for plaque psoriasis
Vehicle/form: Alcohol-free foam, pressurized can
Skin or hair type: Suitable for all skin types; designed for hair-bearing areas including textured and protective styles
Used for: Plaque psoriasis of the scalp and body in adults and adolescents 12 years and older
Black-owned business: No
Certified cruelty-free: No
Certified organic: No
Vegan: No



KEY FINDINGS

4 SAFETY Low Risk

Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.

2 RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABLE Limited

There is limited published data on the use of this product or its ingredients by the Black community.

RECOMMENDATION: This product is generally safe when used as directed on the label. Based on the ingredient profile, the overall risk of irritation or allergy is low. People with moderate to severe liver disease must not use this medicine. Rare sensitivities can occur with fatty alcohols, hexylene glycol, or parabens. The foam is flammable until dry, so keep it away from open flames and hot styling tools. Always follow the product label for safe use.

There is limited information specifically about how well this product works in Black people. The available evidence does not suggest reduced benefit, but the number of Black participants in clinical studies has been small. Consider starting with careful, consistent use on a few affected areas and watch for skin irritation, new bumps around the hairline, or color changes in treated spots. If reactions occur, pause use and speak with a clinician.

SUPPORTING DATA AND ANALYSIS

Key Area	Findings
Active ingredients	Roflumilast 0.3% (3 mg/g).
Inactive ingredients	- Cetareth-10 phosphate, cetearyl phosphate, cetostearyl alcohol, diethylene glycol monoethyl ether, hexylene glycol, isopropyl palmitate, methylparaben, propylparaben, purified water, sodium hydroxide, white petrolatum. Hydrochloric acid may be added to adjust pH. - Propellants: butane, isobutane, propane.

Formulation concerns	• Contraindication: Do not use if you have moderate to severe liver disease (Child-Pugh B or C). • Flammability: Aerosol propellants are flammable; keep away from flames and hot styling tools during and right after use. • Allergens/irritants (rare): Fatty alcohols (cetostearyl/cetearyl), hexylene glycol, parabens (methyl-, propyl-). • Acne/folliculitis risk at hairline: Isopropyl palmitate and occlusives can contribute to breakouts at edges/temples, especially with heavy stylers or tight headwear. • Sting zones: Higher chance of tingling or irritation on thin or occluded skin (face, folds, genitals). • Build-up: Any leave-on can accumulate along part lines in protective or locked hairstyles; monitor itch or small bumps where product sits.
Research and ingredient analysis	• Active ingredient: Roflumilast reduces inflammation and itch. Some people report early itch relief within the first few days. • Evidence in Black people: In the main psoriasis foam study, a small proportion of treated participants identified as Black, and the study did not report results by race. A meaningful portion of participants had darker skin tones, which supports some relevance, but this is not the same as data among Black patients. • Why the research rating is “Limited”: The percentage of Black participants who received the medicine in randomized studies falls within the lowest bracket of representation, and there are no published results that separate outcomes by race. • Hair and scalp access: Foam helps reach the scalp through dense, curly, or protective styles better than many creams or ointments, which can support day-to-day use. • Sensitive areas: If there is concern about irritation or color change, check a small area first and increase slowly, while following the label.
Data sources to consider	• Zoryve (roflumilast) topical foam, 0.3% — Full Prescribing Information (Revision 05/2025) https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2025/217242s005lbl.pdf • Roflumilast Topical Foam 0.3% Multidisciplinary Review — U.S. Food and Drug Administration https://www.fda.gov/media/188146/download • Efficacy and Safety of Roflumilast Foam, 0.3%, in Patients With Scalp and Body Psoriasis: The ARRECTOR Randomized Clinical Trial — JAMA Dermatology https://www.jamanetwork.com/journals/jamadermatology/fullarticle/2833460 • Efficacy and Safety of Roflumilast Foam, 0.3%, in Patients With Scalp and Body Psoriasis: The ARRECTOR Randomized Clinical Trial — PubMed Central https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12060019/ • NCT05028582 — Study of Roflumilast Foam 0.3% in Subjects With Scalp Psoriasis https://clinicaltrials.gov/ct2/show/NCT05028582 • Scalp Psoriasis — National Psoriasis Foundation https://www.psoriasis.org/scalp/ • Psoriasis in People With Skin of Color: An Evidence-Based Update — International Journal of Dermatology (Open Access) https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11931096/ • Safety Assessment of Hexylene Glycol as Used in Cosmetics — Cosmetic Ingredient Review https://cir-reports.cir-safety.org/view-attachment/?id=d28d9d62-8d74-ec11-8943-0022482f06a6 • Opinion on Transcutol (Diethylene Glycol Monoethyl Ether) — Scientific Committee on Consumer Safety https://ec.europa.eu/health/scientific_committees/consumer_safety/docs/sccs_o_119.pdf

— See the legend on page 3 for a description of our scoring system. —

Last reviewed: October 2025

UNDERSTANDING YOUR RESULTS

WeSeeColor evaluates products by examining the ingredients listed on product labels and reviewing available scientific research and literature on both the products and their individual ingredients. Each product is rated on a 5-point scale, considering ingredient safety (and the potential for adverse reactions), the availability of data and research, and documented efficacy on Black skin and hair, when available.

SAFETY RATING

Very High Risk	High Risk	Moderate Risk	Low Risk	Very Low Risk
				
Caution. Strong likelihood that this product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Seek medical attention if exposed.	This product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Be careful and consult your physician.	In certain situations, this product may cause irritation or an allergic reaction. Speak with your physician to learn more.	Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.	Safe to use on most occasions. Product ingredients have negligible irritancy or allergy potential.

RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABILITY RATING

None	Limited	Fair	Good	Robust
				
There is no data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is limited published data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is a fair amount of published data or documented usage in the Black community.	Product or its ingredients have been studied extensively or used extensively in the Black community.	This product or its ingredients have been studied extensively, used extensively, and known in the Black community.

GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Dietary supplements can have unexpected interactions with other products, drugs, or conditions. If the product is characterized as a dietary supplement, we recommend starting with a small intake and monitoring for potential side or adverse effects and consult with a licensed professional before resuming use.
- Allergens may sometimes be listed in labels using their scientific name (e.g. “arachis hypogaea oil” for “peanut oil”). Familiarize yourself with the scientific name of any ingredient to which you may be allergic and review the label carefully before starting usage.